

CURRENT AFFAIRS HANDBOOK: JANUARY 2026

This monthly handbook is meticulously designed for competitive exam aspirants (B.Ed, CTET, TET,)

1. MAJOR NATIONAL AFFAIRS

Approval of Census of India 2027

- **Background:** The national census is a vital exercise for data-driven governance and policy planning.
- **Important Facts:** The Union Cabinet approved the conduct of the Census of India 2027 with an estimated budget of **₹11,718.24 crore**.
- **Key Points:**
 - The census will occur in two phases: Houselisting & Housing Census (April–September 2026) and Population Enumeration (February 2027).
 - Special regions like Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, and Uttarakhand will have enumeration in September 2026 due to weather conditions.
 - **Caste data** will be collected electronically during the second phase.
 - Data will be accessible via a "Census-as-a-Service" (CaaS) model for ministries and researchers.
- **Why Important:** It marks the first census to use electronic data collection and integrates caste data for improved demographic insights.
- **Exam-Oriented Notes:** Note the budget (₹11,718.24 cr) and the implementation of Census-as-a-Service (CaaS).
- **Quick Revision Summary:** Census 2027 approved with two phases and electronic caste data collection.

Cyber Security Innovation Challenge (CSIC) 1.0

- **Background:** India aims to fortify its digital infrastructure against increasing global cyber threats.
- **Important Facts:** Launched by the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** under the ISEA Project.
- **Key Points:**
 - Involves collaboration between CERT-In, AICTE, C-DAC, and academic institutions.
 - Targets critical sectors like BFSI (Banking, Financial Services, and Insurance), healthcare, and telecom.
 - Focuses on domains such as Cryptography, Cyber Forensics, and Fintech Security.

- **Why Important:** It bridges the gap between academic learning and real-world cybersecurity demands.
- **Exam-Oriented Notes:** Focus on the acronym MeitY and the involvement of the ISEA project.
- **Quick Revision Summary:** A national strategy to enhance cybersecurity through student engagement and industry collaboration.

2. INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

The 'New G20' for 2026 Summit

- **Background:** The US is preparing for its first G20 presidency since 2009.
- **Important Facts:** The US unveiled a restructured "**New G20**" for the 2026 Miami Summit, including **Poland** as a new member.
- **Key Points:**
 - **South Africa** has been excluded from participation.
 - US Secretary of State Marco Rubio criticized the previous South African presidency for "radical agendas."
 - Core themes: Removing regulatory burdens and unlocking secure energy supplies.
- **Why Important:** Represents a significant geopolitical shift in the composition and priorities of the world's leading economies.
- **Quick Revision Summary:** US adds Poland and removes South Africa from its 2026 G20 framework.

Italy: UNESCO Recognition for National Cuisine

- **Background:** Italy sought to protect its culinary traditions as part of its cultural identity.
- **Important Facts:** Italy became the first country to have its **entire national cuisine** recognized by UNESCO on the Intangible Cultural Heritage List.
- **Key Points:**
 - Signifies the global cultural importance of Italian cooking traditions.
 - UNESCO recognition helps in the preservation and promotion of these practices worldwide.
- **Quick Revision Summary:** Italian cuisine is now a UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage.

3. ECONOMY & BANKING

National Strategy for Financial Inclusion (NSFI) 2025-30

- **Background:** RBI aims to sustain the momentum of including all citizens in the formal banking system.
- **Important Facts:** RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra released the five-year strategy for 2025–2030.
- **Key Points:**
 - Focuses on linking livelihood and skill development to financial services.
 - Emphasizes financial education for better customer protection and grievance redressal.
- **Why Important:** It seeks to move beyond mere bank accounts to meaningful financial engagement.
- **Quick Revision Summary:** RBI's new 5-year plan targets deeper financial education and customer protection.

Banking - Short Briefs

- **Domestic Systemically Important Banks (D-SIBs):** RBI retained **SBI, HDFC Bank, and ICICI Bank** as banks "too big to fail," requiring higher capital reserves.
- **Net FDI Inflow:** Net FDI to India doubled to **\$7.64 billion** in the first half of FY26 compared to \$3.4 billion the previous year.
- **Indian Digital Payment Intelligence Corporation (IDPIC):** Formed by SBI and Bank of Baroda to prevent digital payment fraud.
- **PaRRVA:** SEBI launched the **Past Risk and Return Verification Agency** to verify the historical performance of market intermediaries.

4. GOVERNMENT SCHEMES

Scheme Title	Objective	Key Details
Viksit Bharat - G RAM G Act	Replace MGNREGA with a new rural employment framework.	Raises statutory work guarantee to 125 days and links it to rural infrastructure.
PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana	Promote rooftop solar installation.	Demand-driven scheme; aimed at providing free electricity to households.
Tex-RAMPS	Boost textiles research and innovation.	Total outlay of ₹305 crore for the period 2025–2031.
TEAM Scheme	Empower MSMEs through digital infrastructure.	Outlay of ₹277.35 crore; leverages the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) .

5. SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Skyroot's Infinity Campus

- **Background:** Private sector participation in space is a key pillar of India's space reforms.
- **Important Facts:** PM Modi inaugurated **Infinity Campus**, a massive rocket manufacturing facility in Hyderabad.
- **Key Points:**
 - The 2-lakh square feet facility can build **one orbital rocket every month**.
 - Launch of **Vikram-I**, an orbital rocket capable of placing satellites into orbit.
- **Why Important:** Establishes India's capability in high-frequency, commercial satellite launches.
- **Quick Revision Summary:** Hyderabad becomes a hub for private rocket manufacturing via Skyroot Aerospace.

DHRUV64 Microprocessor

- **Background:** Part of the India Semiconductor Mission to achieve self-reliance in high-end electronics.
- **Important Facts:** C-DAC announced the **DHRUV64** microprocessor.
- **Key Points:**
 - Suitable for 5G infrastructure, IoT, and automotive systems.
 - Designed for seamless integration with external hardware systems.
- **Quick Revision Summary:** An indigenous high-performance microprocessor for industrial and consumer tech.

6. ENVIRONMENT & CLIMATE

Solid Waste Management (SWM) Rules 2026

- **Background:** India is updating its waste management framework to handle rapid urbanization.
- **Important Facts:** New rules mandate that waste must be segregated into **four streams at the source**.
- **Key Points:**
 - Categories: Wet, Dry, Sanitary, and Special Care Waste.
 - Introduces the **"Polluter Pays" principle** for bulk waste generators.
 - Promotes "Waste-to-Energy" by increasing Refuse Derived Fuel (RDF) usage from 5% to 15%.
- **Why Important:** Aims for 100% circularity and reduces the burden on landfills.
- **Exam-Oriented Notes:** Remember the "four-stream" segregation requirement.
- **Quick Revision Summary:** Mandatory 4-category waste segregation and focus on waste-to-energy.

Environmental Reports

- **World Bank Report:** “*A Breath of Change 2025*” focuses on air pollution in the **Indo-Gangetic Plain**, warning of significant GDP loss.
- **Groundwater Quality 2025:** Indicates **13–15%** of groundwater samples in India are contaminated with **uranium**.

7. DEFENCE & SECURITY

- **INS Mahe:** Commissioned as the first of its class of indigenous anti-submarine warfare shallow water crafts.
- **Exercise EKUVERIN:** Joint military training between **India and Maldives** (meaning 'Friends' in Dhivehi).
- **Exercise DESERT CYCLONE-II:** Second edition of the joint military exercise between **India and UAE** held in Abu Dhabi.
- **Sai Jadhav:** Became the first woman officer to graduate from the **Indian Military Academy (IMA)**, breaking a 93-year record.
- **Fighter Aircraft Escape System:** DRDO successfully tested a new indigenous ejection system.

8. SPORTS

Event	Winner/Highlight Key Detail	
Formula 1	Lando Norris	Won his maiden F1 World Title at the Abu Dhabi Grand Prix.
Archery Premier League Inaugural Season (APL)	World's first professional archery league held in New Delhi.	
Cricket Milestone	Sunil Narine	Reached 500 matches in World ILT20.
Junior Hockey World Cup	Germany	Defeated Spain to win the Men’s title.

9. AWARDS & HONOURS

- **FIFA Peace Prize:** Awarded to **Donald Trump** for efforts in promoting international peace.
- **Champions of the Earth (UNEP):** Won by **Supriya Sahu** (Tamil Nadu) for her work in climate action and nature-based solutions.
- **Order of Oman:** Conferred upon **PM Narendra Modi** for boosting India-Oman ties.
- **Time Person of the Year 2025:** “**Architects of AI**” recognized for their societal impact.

10. IMPORTANT APPOINTMENTS

- **Raj Kumar Goyal:** Sworn in as the **Chief Information Commissioner (CIC)**.
- **Usha Janakiraman:** Appointed as **Executive Director** at the RBI.
- **Harmanpreet Kaur:** Named the first female brand ambassador for **Punjab National Bank (PNB)**.
- **Ravi Ranjan:** Took charge as the new Managing Director of **SBI**.

11. REPORTS & INDEXES

- **Passport Index 2025 (Arton Capital):** UAE ranked as the world's strongest passport.
- **Global AI Vibrancy Index:** India scored 21.59, ranking high in talent but slipping slightly in policy governance.
- **Richest Families (Bloomberg):** The **Walton family** (Walmart) remains the world's richest (\$513.4 bn).

12. SUMMITS & CONFERENCES

- **BRICS Presidency:** Brazil formally handed over the BRICS presidency to **India** for 2026.
- **India–AI Impact Summit 2026:** India will host this global summit in New Delhi in February.
- **6th International Agronomy Congress:** Inaugurated by Shivraj Singh Chouhan in New Delhi.
- **23rd India–Russia Annual Summit:** Reaffirmed the "Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership."

13. IMPORTANT DAYS

- **December 1:** World AIDS Day (Reflected in Jan reporting).
- **December 4:** International Cheetah Day.
- **December 14:** National Energy Conservation Day.
- **December 20:** International Human Solidarity Day (Theme: "Solidarity for Sustainable Development").

14. STATE-WISE CURRENT AFFAIRS

- **Rajasthan:** Became the first state to **100% digitize voter rolls** under SIR-2026.

- **Kerala:** First state to waive **undergraduate tuition fees** for Arts and Science students.
- **Uttar Pradesh:** First **Forest University** to be established in Gorakhpur.
- **Madhya Pradesh:** Developing India's first **state-level tiger corridor** connecting multiple national parks.
- **Gujarat:** Implementing "**Smart Blue Harbours**" using AI and 5G at Jakhau.
- **Nagaland:** Hosted the globally acclaimed **Hornbill Festival** at Kisama.

QUICK REVISION SUPPLEMENT

One-Liner Revision Notes

- India currently has **98 Ramsar sites** with the addition of Patna Bird Sanctuary and Chhari-Dhand.
- The **G RAM G Act** has replaced the old MGNREGA framework.
- **Oxford's Word of the Year 2025** is "Rage bait."
- **Indo-Gangetic Plain** is the focus of the World Bank's *A Breath of Change* report.
- **Sai Jadhav** is the first woman officer from the Indian Military Academy.

MCQs with Answers

1. **Which state has announced free education up to the graduation level for Arts and Science?**
 - A) Tamil Nadu B) Kerala C) Punjab D) Bihar
 - **Answer: B) Kerala**
2. **What is the budget for the Census of India 2027?**
 - A) ₹8,000 cr B) ₹15,200 cr C) ₹11,718.24 cr D) ₹5,500 cr
 - **Answer: C) ₹11,718.24 cr**
3. **Which city hosted the inaugural Archery Premier League (APL)?**
 - A) Mumbai B) Hyderabad C) New Delhi D) Kolkata
 - **Answer: C) New Delhi**

Important Abbreviations

- **CSIC:** Cyber Security Innovation Challenge
- **D-SIB:** Domestic Systemically Important Bank
- **IDPIC:** Indian Digital Payment Intelligence Corporation
- **PaRRVA:** Past Risk and Return Verification Agency
- **RDF:** Refuse Derived Fuel

Important Organizations & Personalities

- **Skyroot Aerospace:** Hyderabad-based space-tech startup.
- **Raj Kumar Goyal:** New Chief Information Commissioner.
- **Lando Norris:** McLaren driver and maiden F1 champion.
- **Supriya Sahu:** Winner of the UNEP Champions of the Earth award.